Research evidence and its limits

We keep dated source records separate from later synthesis. An interview report, a field observation and a measured service outcome carry different kinds of weight.

Date / source	What the record is	What it contributed	What it does not establish
4 Sep / S02 brief	Assigned Mandarin Oriental brief.	Expectation management, operational complexity, cost to serve and the commercial intent after booking.	An audited NPS model, quantified process baseline or verified current operating performance.
7 Sep / Kate transcript	Proxy stakeholder account.	Context for the halted personalisation effort and the tension between recognition and fulfilment.	A full failure report or direct testimony from all affected departments.
12 Sep / final deck	Five guest conversations reported in the research summary.	Four of five said an assistant arranged their booking; this supported our chosen focus.	A representative share of guests or independent verification of wealth or VIP status.
16 Sep / MO meeting	Further MO interview and meeting summary.	Agent involvement, high-touch service context and operational constraints.	The raw booking dataset behind the reported 95% estimate.
19 Sep / assistant PDF	One machine-transcribed assistant conversation.	Trusted-channel counterexample; privacy concerns; optional menus, visible choices and manager acknowledgement.	Behaviour on the final prototype. Identity linkage to the three-agent summary is not confirmed.
Undated / site & review work	Shenzhen visit, three-agent synthesis and 16-review coding in the final deck.	Dream Maker discovery; selected accounts of coordination and situational service.	Uniform practice across properties, a complaint rate or a service improvement.
Supplied / GXP deck	35-slide internal programme / training material.	Existing preference taxonomy, Today workflow, traces, minimum guidance and a proposed Tomorrow workflow.	Verified rollout status, the stopped pilot’s failure analysis, or live property compliance.
5 Oct / project context	Working migration summary and room-prototype archive.	Evolution of the spatial interface and issues still open at that date.	Final approved requirements, user-test results or live system integration.

We use anonymised research summaries. We omit private third-party details that are irrelevant to the service-design question.